



01

■ DOCUMENTATION IN THE AGE OF AI

Why We Should View Docs as a Product



02

■ START WITH THE USER

Who reads your docs?

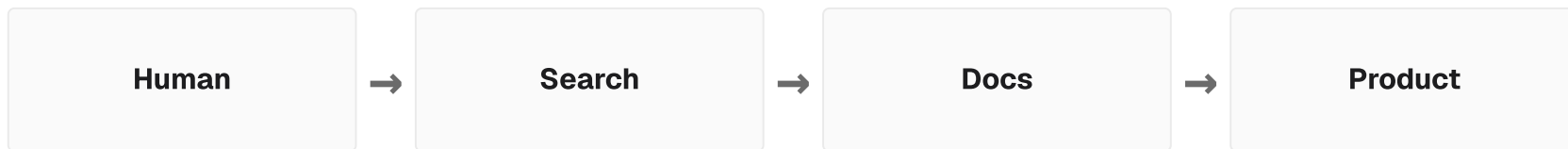
And what counts as “reading”?



03

■ WHEN PEOPLE READ DOCS

The documentation page was the experience.



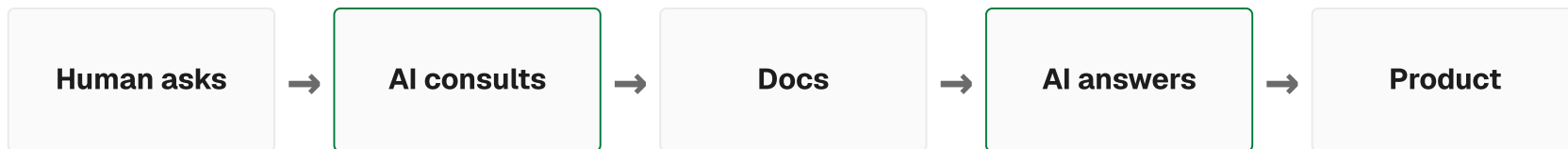


04

■ HOW PEOPLE USE DOCS NOW

The path now has an intermediary.

A person asks. An agent consults the docs. The person acts.





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■ REQUEST COMPARISON

**On GitBook platforms,
AI agents already
request pages about
as often as people do.**

HUMAN REQUESTS 48.2%



**AI-AGENT
REQUESTS 51.8%**



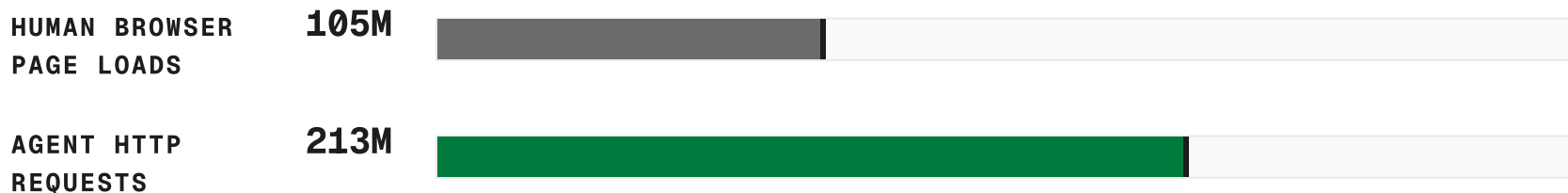
Requests, not unique readers; eligible GitBook-hosted sites only; crawler and other-bot categories excluded.



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■ ACROSS ANOTHER PLATFORM

**On Mintlify platforms,
agent requests already
outnumber human
traffic two to one.**



July 2026 vs. start of 2026, Mintlify-hosted docs only; classified differently than the GitBook figures above, not one trend.



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■ WHY QUALITY MATTERS

Bad docs become bad actions.

The agent follows the wrong path. The task fails. The user feels the frustration.



What that looks like in practice.

01 Own it

A product owner for docs; PMs and engineers own the truth

02 Build it fast

Low-friction drafting: agentic tooling, human in the loop

03 Keep it correct

Automated checks in CI (spectral for OpenAPI) before publish

04 Make it reachable

llms.txt, MCP, and pages you can copy as Markdown (`.md`)

05 Learn and improve

Analytics, user feedback, and a maintenance roadmap



The system and content need different owners.

DOCS PRODUCT OWNER

Owns the system

Infrastructure, publishing, agentic authoring tools, discovery, and usability

FEATURE PMS + ENGINEERS

Own the content

Accuracy, initial drafts, and maintenance as the product changes



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■ DOCS AS PRODUCT —————

Start with a user and a task.



Measure whether the user can complete the task.

A request $\neq$ A completed task

The same task must succeed for a person and an agent.



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■ A PRACTICAL WORKFLOW

Use AI to draft, not to decide.

AI TOOLS

Draft

TRUTH OWNERS

Review

CI CHECKS

Gate

DOCS SYSTEM

Publish

TRUTH OWNERS

Maintain



Keep one source of truth. Serve every reader.

FOR PEOPLE

Readable site docs

Browse, search, and copy a page as `.md`.

SOURCE OF TRUTH

Canonical documentation

Versioned, reviewed, and maintained.

FOR AGENTS

Useful access paths

`llms.txt` · `llms-full.txt` ·
MCP tools

Use these as representations and interfaces, not competing sources of truth.



Let real use shape the roadmap.

MEASURE

Watch the signals

Top searches, and whether AI chats actually answer, or come up empty

LISTEN

Act on feedback

Capture it and ship it, crediting the community, not individuals

IMPROVE

Plan the work

A maintenance roadmap that keeps every task doable, for agents and people

Treat documentation as a product.



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Own the system. Maintain the truth. Measure task success.



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